# 2006 Toyota Prius (hybrid)

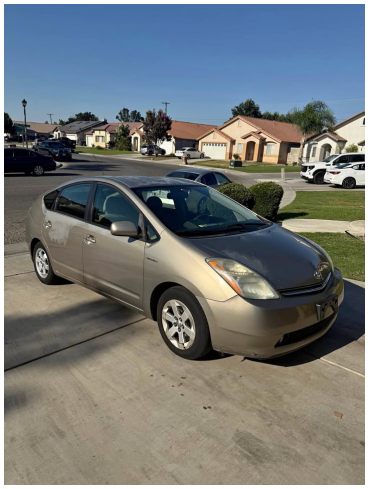
$4,300 · 143,000 miles · Private seller · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Private seller

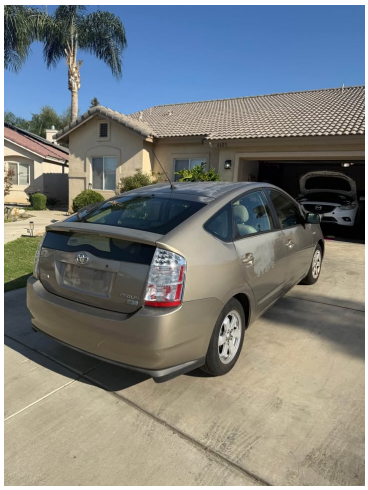
Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1581711653596876/

Report generated October 28, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 1 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$4,881** | **$318** | **Average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 3/5 · 6 recalls · 1,439 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $4,300.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $397.75 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $27.95 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $32.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $4,880.70 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $4,880.70 |
| Amount financed | $0.00 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,030.70 |

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $0.00 |
| Insurance (estimate, liability) | $70.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 46 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $103.26 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $130.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $14.83 |
| Total per month | $318.09 |

Running costs without the loan: **$318/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$8,848** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Average (3/5)**

Same as the 2008: an excellent design, but at 20 years old the hybrid battery and brake actuator are the big-ticket risks. Priced low enough to leave room for a battery if needed.

NHTSA data for this model year: 6 recalls · 1,439 owner complaints (82 involving a crash). Most complaints: Exterior Lighting (941), Service Brakes (214), Electrical System (152), Hydraulic (94), Vehicle Speed Control (84), Electric (45).

**Known issues for this model**

• Hybrid battery capacity loss with age

• Brake actuator / ABS pump failure

• Combination meter failure

• Oil consumption / EGR at high miles

**Check on this car before buying**

• Hybrid battery health test before buying

• No triangle/ABS/check-engine lights

• Confirm the smog certificate date

• Confirm availability by phone before the 2-hour drive

## Notes

$4,300, 143k mi. Clean title in hand, smog done, no check-engine light, A/C/heat, cruise. Listed ~9 weeks.

One seller review says they were ghosted after a long drive - confirm by phone the day you go.

~48 city MPG for $4,300 - the cheapest way to low gas costs on this list.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-178). Confirm availability and get an out-the-door price by phone/text before driving.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.